

“We’re just building the foundation in India”

Evan Spiegel, Co-founder & CEO of social media firm Snap, talks about advertising, profitability, and the India story

PHOTOS BY **BANDEEP SINGH**

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In his white Celine shoes, Evan Spiegel looks every bit the successful young entrepreneur that he is. The 33-year-old Co-founder & CEO of the \$4.6-billion Snap Inc. doesn't pull any punches. Having made a name with the multimedia messaging app, his firm is now focussing on India. On a recent visit to India, Spiegel took time out to speak to

Business Today's *Sourav Majumdar* and *Krishna Gopalan* on AI, privacy, AR vs VR, and the road ahead. Edited excerpts:

Q: You are in India at a time when there is a lot of activity. Do you like what you see?

A: The Snapchat community is growing and we have over 200 million users in India. I understand that's still a small number. So, I am excited about the opportunity and just seeing the way young people are expressing themselves through augmented reality (AR) experiences. We have connected with developers who are making so many new AR experiences. And of course, there are folks who are creating videos, sharing them with their friends, expressing themselves and communicating with Snapchat. **I like the way our product is resonating here in India. It is a great honour to be here and to connect with our community.**